Golden West College

CS G231 Syllabus
Spring 2026
January 31 – May 30, 2026
Python Programming 2

Instructor: Cristian Racataian

Office hours: Language Arts 207, Tuesday 4:00 pm – 6:00 pm
Canvas: CCCD Zoom -> Appointments: 15 min. time slot reservation.
Wednesday: 3:00 pm – 5:00 pm

Phone: (714) 892-7711 x 51225

E-mail: **Canvas** (primary)
cracataian@gwc.cccd.edu (include your full-name, course, section)

While I do have a college email, I would encourage students to use the Canvas email. If you use the college email you may not get a timely response.

This online course includes consistent, instructor-initiated interaction throughout the semester. I will communicate weekly through announcements, feedback on assignments, and participation in discussion forums. I will also be available for on-campus and virtual office hours and respond to messages within 24-48 hours. Students can expect meaningful feedback on major assignments within one week or longer depending on the student requests for extensions. Regular engagement and instructor-led discussions are integral to your success in this course.

As part of **Regular Substantive Interaction (RSI)**, I offer weekly office hours for all my students. These office hours are not mandatory; however, they offer a great resource for questions you might have about assignments, lecture materials, or your grade. It is helpful to send me a Canvas Message to let me know what you'd like to discuss.

Course Description

This course covers data structures and object-oriented programming (OOP) concepts using the Python language. Arrays, queues, stacks, linked-lists, trees, hashing, graphs, recursion, sorting, searching, optimization, classes, objects, inheritance, polymorphism, and algorithm complexity will be discussed and practiced.

Prerequisite:

CS G131: Python Programming 1 with a minimum grade of C or better
or
CS G153: Java Programming 1 with a minimum grade of C or better
or
CS G175: C++ Programming 1 with a minimum grade of C or better

Student Learning Outcomes:

The successful student will be able to:

1. Implement object-oriented class hierarchy and inheritance.
2. Apply complex data storage mechanisms and manipulation algorithms.
3. Develop programs that use abstract data structures.

Textbook: ***Data Structures and Algorithms in Python, Addison-Wesley***

Authors: John Canning, Alan Broder, Robert Lafore
Publisher: Person Education, Inc., 2023
ISBN-10: 013485568X
ISBN-13: 978 0134855684

Software: https://www.python.org/
Python 3.X (latest version is recommended)

Letter Grade: 10 programming assignments x 100 points each = 1000 pts.

Total possible points: 1000 pts.

A:	90% and above	900 and above points
B:	80-89%	800 – 899 points
C:	70-79%	700 – 799 points
D:	60-69%	600 – 699 points
F:	below 60%	below 600 points

Course Withdrawal/Drop Policy:
If you are unable to fulfill the course requirements, **it is your responsibility** to drop the class. If you stop participating in online activities and do not complete required course work, without officially dropping the course you will receive an F.

The instructor can drop the student any time before the withdrawal date due to failure to attend/progress in the class (progressing consists of logging onto Canvas and doing the homework).

Attendance:
Students are expected to participate in all online activities that are assigned. The lab portion of the class is mandatory and will have specific online instructions.

If you anticipate any changes in work schedules or any activities (vacation, weddings, surgeries, court dates, etc) that may result in excessive missed work and/or participation, I suggest you consider taking this course at a time you can commit to the entire semester. Every week is important. We cover a lot of information and it is very difficult to catch up and be successful in this class when you fall behind.

Assignments:
Log into Canvas and be ready to participate and learn. Through diligent work and motivation, you can expect your experience with the class to be rewarding and well worth your effort!

Students are expected to participate in course activities which include online discussions, and assignments/activities. All assignment/lab instructions are posted on Canvas and will be submitted to the instructor through Canvas upload facility.

Important: ASIGNMENTS CANNOT BE RE-SUBMITTED FOR BETTER GRADE.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Usage:
Students are permitted to use AI agents for class work if the final product complies exactly with the assignment requirements. Submissions that produce similar results but do not comply with the requirements will not be accepted.

Please consider that this course is about fundamental concepts in data structures usage. AI is in its infancy, and the time it takes to generate the exact same code implementation would be much better spent in acquiring the more valuable programming skill.

Cheating:
Submitting the same code like other students with only minor modifications is cheating and will not be tolerated. -- Lab work is excluded from this policy.
Cheating will not be tolerated. Anyone suspected of cheating will be referred to the Dean for appropriate action which can include failure of the assignment, failure of the course, and expulsion from Golden West College.

All work submitted for grading must meet college level standards.

Late Policy:
Late assignments **will be accepted until the last day of class** with deductions of up to 50% of the assignment worth. The actual deduction depends upon the amount of time the assignment is past due.
NO SUBMISSIONS WILL BE ACCEPTED AFTER THE LAST DAY OF CLASS.

Communication:
It is absolutely your responsibility to read and understand what is required of you for this class as it is outlined in the syllabus and through Canvas postings.

If you do not understand or comprehend assignment instructions or textbook material, please do not hesitate to contact me so that we can go over it together. Canvas email is the best way to contact me.

Important Dates:

Last date to add class:	16-FEB-2026
Last date to drop with a refund:	14-FEB-2026
Last date to drop without a "W":	16-FEB-2026
Last date to drop with a "W":	03-MAY-2026

STUDENT RESOURCES

Disabled Students Programs and Services (DSPS)

https://www.goldenwestcollege.edu/dsps/index.html

Golden West College Library:

https://www.goldenwestcollege.edu/library/index.html

Golden West College Student Resources:

https://www.goldenwestcollege.edu/student-resources/index.html

Study Sequence for Topics and Assignments:

Week # Date	Study Items	Assignments*
Week 1: 1/31-2/8	Course Introduction Chapter 1	
Week 2: 2/9-2/15	Chapter 2	Project 1 100 points
Week 3: 2/16-2/22	Chapter 3	
Week 4: 2/23-3/1	Chapter 4	Project 2 100 pts.
Week 5: 3/2-3/8	Chapter 5	Project 3 100 pts.
Week 6: 3/9-3/15	Chapter 6	
Week 7: 3/16-3/22	Chapter 7	Project 4 100 pts.
Week 8: 3/23-3/29	Chapter 8	Project 5 100 pts.
3/30-4/5	Spring Recess	
Week 9: 4/6-4/12	Chapter 9	
Week 10: 4/13-4/19	Chapter 9	Project 6 100 points
Week 11: 4/20-4/26	Chapter 10	Project 7 100 pts.
Week 12: 4/27-5/3	Chapter 11	
Week 13: 5/4-5/10	Chapter 11	Project 8 100 pts.
Week 14: 5/11-5/17	Chapter 14	Project 9 100 pts.
Week 15: 5/18-5/24	Chapter 15	
Week 16: 5/25-5/30	Chapter 16	Project 10 100 pts.
Total Points	**1000 pts.**	

*Project due dates will be posted on Canvas